James McKnight

New Orleans, LA

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EDUCATION

Tulane University, A. B. Freeman School of Business New Orleans, LA
Bachelor of Science in Management, Double Major in Finance and Legal Studies in Business 2018 - 2022
Notable Programs: Burkenroad Reports, Darwin Fenner Investment Fund

EXPERIENCE

International Matex Tank Terminaling (IMTT) New Orleans, LA
Corporate Development Analyst April 2024 – Present

- Own and build 100% of commercial DCF models and ~50% of corporate development models used to evaluate and inform investment and commercial decisions. Have completed 40+ models across opportunities ranging from $50K facility upgrades to $150MM strategic initiatives resulting in 25+ deal closures $500MM+ of capital deployment across IMTT's terminal network
- Improved project underwriting accuracy by refining terminal-level tax and insurance assumptions, helping avoid blanket inputs that could have led to mispricing or rejection of attractive opportunities
- Identified a prospective customer's limited alternatives through commercial and market analysis, driving a pricing recommendation that suggested a proposed fee 75% above the original proposal plan, which ultimately generated ~$12MM of incremental EBITDA
- Own and maintain a complex dock utilization model used in quarterly executive updates to inform decisions on future project development and site capacity based on customer volume trends, dock constraints, and contract-specific operating nuances
- Led CRM platform selection and implementation to migrate the commercial and business development teams from Excel-based relationship tracking, then led workflow design, custom reporting logic, automation buildout, and user training
- Served as lead CRM administrator and developed multiple CRM automations used daily by 20 team members, including a proprietary activity tracker that notifies sales reps when to re-engage customers based on relationship cadence and account activity
- Streamlined project evaluation and diligence workflows by developing standardized modeling tools, including a commercial model template, a dynamic, nearly fully automated dock simulation model, and a buy-versus-lease capex framework adopted by operations leadership across all terminals

Fidelis New Energy, LLC (Acquired in 2026 as AIP Corp by NScale) Houston, TX
Summer Intern, Analyst, Senior Analyst Summer 2021, August 2022 – April 2024

- Developed project finance models for a range of decarbonization opportunities, supporting development decisions across projects representing $8B+ of combined capex.
- Led coordination of a $9 million grant application for CO2 transportation and storage, saving the company $400K+ in external consulting fees. Managed procurement of 30+ supporting documents totaling 120+ pages
- Evaluated hundreds of grant opportunities for clean hydrogen/ammonia, CCS, SAF, and renewable diesel and performed in-depth financial and project timeline analysis to determine both eligibility and feasibility, supporting applications for over $125 million in new federal grant awards
- Helped develop proprietary community benefits program used for each of Fidelis' projects
- Used writing skills to regularly draft letters of support and letters of intent as well as commentary for legislators, potential partners, and other stakeholders

Etsy / Print-on-Demand E-commerce Business New Orleans, LA
Founder Summer, 2025 – Present

- Generate $500+ in monthly revenue across approximately 50 sales per month while limiting upkeep to roughly 2 hours per month through automation and streamlined operations

- Manage a catalog of 50+ products, overseeing product design, pricing, listings, and fulfillment workflows
- Built a web-based analytics dashboard hosted on a using claude code to get visuals and LLM generated summaries of sales trends

AI-ASSISTED WEB DEVELOPMENT / APP PORTFOLIO

- Built web applications using Claude Code, including a marine movement dashboard, productivity and goals tracker/dashboard, a personal relationship management platform, and a credit card spending and rewards tracker
- Designed and deployed websites for my own personal site, Sixth Street Creative and Magazine St. Listening Room using multiple AI tools, GitHub, and Cloudflare

Skills and Interests

Technical Skills: Excel, Power Automate, Claude Code, Microsoft Copilot, PowerPoint, Word, Google Earth, Vortexa, Macabacus, Photoshop, Tableau, Bloomberg, Capital IQ, Python, Microsoft Project

Interests/Hobbies: Travel, Reading, Live Music, Golf, Football, Backpacking, Fly Fishing, Personal Finance & Investing, Vibe Coding